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Netanyahu's legacy on line in vote

Israelis head to polls in first election since Oct. 7 Hamas attack

By Josef Federman
ASSOCIATED PRESS

JERUSALEM — When Hamas-led militants attacked Israel on Oct. 7, 2023, it looked like Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's days in office were numbered.

With the country overwhelmed by grief and anger after the deadliest security breakdown in its history, his resignation seemed like a matter of time.

But the divisive veteran Israeli leader has scratched, scraped and literally battled his way back during a stormy three-year period of nonstop domestic crises and wars across the region. Confounding his critics, he now finds himself in a tight race for reelection on Tuesday.

Netanyahu has been the country's most dominant politician for nearly two decades, and his legacy is on the line. A poor showing could end the 77-year-old's lengthy career on a bitter note and open the door to a new era in Israeli politics. A victory would cement his image as the ultimate political survivor.

Former Prime Minister Ehud Olmert, a onetime ally turned rival of Netanyahu, said there has never been so much at stake — from national security to the future of Israel's democratic institutions and its standing in the world.

After a series of wars that have destabilized the region and jolted the global economy, the world is watching closely.

Netanyahu's opponents, led by former military chief Gadi Eisenkot, see Tuesday as a day of reckoning. They say Netanyahu should be held accountable for Oct. 7 and the failure to turn battlefield victories into diplomatic achievements.

"What he is offering is an eternal war," Eisenkot, whose son and two nephews were killed in combat, said in a radio interview. "Choosing a leader whose only goal is not to surrender means choosing a leader who will not deliver victories."

Netanyahu's supporters say he was betrayed by Israel's defense establishment and that he has led the country through a remarkable turnaround with devastating strikes against Hamas, Lebanon's Hezbollah and Iran.

The Israeli leader has also turned to his traditional use of scare tactics. His campaign slogan, "Right or Palestine," which rhymes in Hebrew, suggests his opponents would establish a Palestinian state

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ELECTION 2026
LIEUTENANT GOVERNOR

Mitchell, Del Mar vie for job with big stakes

For either side, No. 2 position could take on greater significance

By Jeremy Gorner
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

For most of Illinois' history, the lieutenant governor has been a political afterthought, an office-holder whose unofficial title has been "lite gov" and whose main duty has been to stand ready should the governor die, become incapacitated or be removed from office.

This year, the No. 2 job carries outsize stakes on both tickets.

If Gov. JB Pritzker wins a third term, attention will quickly turn to whether he runs for president in 2028. That would place greater responsibility on his running mate, Democrat Christian Mitchell of Chicago, a former state representative and top Pritzker aide who would become governor if Pritzker wins the White House.

On the Republican side, Aaron Del Mar of Palatine has been far more prominent than a typical running mate, serving as something of an interpreter on Chicago-area and suburban issues for Darren Bailey, the downstate farmer and former state lawmaker who lost to Pritzker four years ago.

"Del Mar, he can speak Republican suburbanese. ... One of his functions in the campaign is to say, 'Well, Bailey understands the suburbs, and I'm going to be here to help him understand it even better.' So I view him as ticket balancing," said Kent Redfield, an emeritus professor of political science at the University of Illinois Springfield. "Politically, Pritzker doesn't need Mitchell to strengthen the ticket, so to speak. That should not be a problem. Why Mitchell makes sense is because of his experience as deputy governor, as a legislator."

Mitchell, who replaced Lt. Gov. Juliana Stratton on the ticket after she launched her U.S. Senate bid, would bring a long resume to the

See **ELECTION** on Page A5

Trump to try to charge Comey again

The Trump administration is again attempting to prosecute James Comey for what it calls a decade-old leak of classified information, an effort the former FBI director's lawyers immediately dismissed. **Nation & World**

Chicago budget negotiations begin

Aldermen question whether Mayor Brandon Johnson's spending plan is truly balanced as budget talks begin at City Hall. **Chicagoland, Page 3**



Smart Paws owner Gina Scaletta walks Cirilla, a client's dog, down Irving Park Road in Chicago, during the early morning on Oct. 13. Permanent daylight saving would make winter mornings extremely dark for Scaletta and the handful of dog walkers she employs. **ANTONIO PEREZ/TRIBUNE**

Right on time, debate on clock shift returns

As legislative effort stalls, opposing sides discuss pros and cons of falling back

By Lila Hempel-Edgers
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Chicagoans are once again debating whether an hour of daylight belongs in the morning or the evening as legislation to end the twice-yearly clock change stalls in the Senate. From doctors and dog walkers to drive-in operators, the dividing lines defy simple explanation.

Some see the ritual as a financial windfall, others as a cruel extinguishing of summer's last light. The only thing everyone seems to agree on, said Chris Prentice, an actor from Edgewater, is that they're right.

"People argue that standard time is a made-up thing," Prentice, 48, said. "And it is, but it's less made up than daylight savings."

Clocks will fall back an hour to standard time on Sunday, part of the biannual adjustment designed to conserve energy and make better use of sunlight. They'll spring forward to daylight saving time in March, costing people an hour of sleep.

The fall shift gives that hour back, but at the expense of evening light. Standard time remains in effect for just a third of the year, much to the dismay of medical experts who say it better aligns the body's internal clock with the natural cycle of the sun. Springing forward in March is associated with poorer sleep and increased risk of heart disease, said Dr. Sabra Abbott, a Northwestern neurologist who specializes in circadian rhythm disorders.

"The entire time that you're on daylight saving time, your body is still trying to follow solar time," Abbott said. "You never fully catch up."

On the other hand, eight months of daylight saving time isn't enough for business owners, who see decreases in foot traffic as evenings get darker. They'd rather stick to daylight saving time year-round, joining a slew of legislative sponsors and tourism advocates who agree that later sunsets encourage consumers to stay out and spend.

President Donald Trump,

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ELECTION 2027 CHICAGO MAYOR

Candidates turn out in last day for signatures

Mayoral contenders show personal flair as they haul in petitions

By Alice Yin and Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

On the last day for 2027 candidates to turn in their nominating petitions, mayoral hopefuls lugged in their stacks of signatures Monday with some personal flair.

Illinois Comptroller Susana Mendoza brought with her a red cooler of chicken and pork tamales and a spork. Cardiologist Dr. Lisa Nee and her team strolled in wearing physician white coats.

Attorney William Quinlan came in over an hour after and took a shot at some of his rivals whom he recently sued: "To be clear ... we're just filing for one" office.

Illinois Secretary of State Alexi Giannoulias and others are also running for reelection in their current posts this November, prompting a lawsuit from Quinlan that was dismissed this month. Quinlan has said he will appeal.

And leading off a late-day flood of candidates entering a lottery for the last spot on the ballot, Cook County Treasurer Maria Pappas took her own shot at Giannoulias, acknowledging her custom t-shirt was directed at him.

"No biceps, just brains," it read in black, all-caps text. "Pappas mayor."

Rounding out the end-of-fil-

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Mayoral candidate Dr. Lisa Nee flexes her muscles after delivering nominating petitions to the Chicago Board of Elections on Monday. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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